



SAFE WATERS

Some areas of shallow sea have been set aside as marine reserves, where fishing is not allowed. This enables wildlife within them to flourish. Since there are no fences around these reserves, the fish and other animals spread into the neighboring waters, dramatically increasing the fish population. So, restricting fishing in some parts of the sea actually improves the catch in nearby areas.



CLEAN SEAS

An important part of marine conservation is stopping the pollution of ocean water. Sewage, for example, gets dumped into coastal seas, while industrial chemicals find their way into rivers and flow into the ocean, where the pollution creates a toxic environment for marine life. Many countries now have laws to ensure the correct treatment of sewage, and to prevent the industrial pollution of rivers that flow into the sea.



▲ POLLUTED RIVER

Pollution from an Asian copper mine pours down a once healthy river. Eventually, it will spill into the sea, smothering and poisoning marine life.

PROTECTING COASTS

In some parts of the world, coastal development has been virtually uncontrolled. Tourist resorts have sprung up on wild coasts with no facilities such as correct drainage, and this has created problems with pollution as well as affecting the natural beauty of the shore. But this practice is changing as local authorities recognize the value of preserving the assets that the tourists come to see. This means conserving the coastline and its wildlife, as well as nearby shallow seas. Many modern resorts are carefully planned to have as little impact on the natural world as possible.

